MEMORIES OF BELLA SIEGEL - JANUARY 22, 1996

"She always smelled like sweet powder." Laurisa

"No bellybutton." Joline

"Her skin was very soft." Estelle

"She always fed the pigeons on the roof next to her." Joline

"She was a sun lover. In the summertime when she took the kids out to a farm, she would take her clothes off and put olive oil on herself and lie out in the sun in the tall grass. The kids were also stripped and greasy with olive oil." Estelle

"When Jack (Zaida) came up for the weekend to the farm, he would bring a large glass jar of hard candy full of jelly that were delicious. But we would see neither one the whole weekend." Estelle

"She had several favorite dishes she cooked - marvelous blintzes, challachkas (stuffed cabbage rolls) and a marvelous stew which she called god damned a flesh because she always burned it." Estelle

"My mother would make a pot full of salad. We would go to the beach and she would stuff Kaiser rolls with the salad and - it was so delicious." Estelle

"Zaida would bite into an onion like it was an apple." Estelle
"Bubby used to sing lullabies - songs in Russian and Yiddish." Estelle

"She used to use marshmallow paste to get her contacts our." Joline

"She was the money manager of the family. She would hide money in the linen closet between sheets and towels. Zaida

couldn't be trusted - he would give money away to relatives." Estelle

"She always wanted to uplift her children to be fine and good and much better than the other children." Estelle

"She saved enough money for a down payment on a new duplex in East Flatbush. She said that whatever you do, try to own your own home." Estelle

"She said to teenage Estelle, 'Never do anything you would be ashamed to tell me about.' Before her wedding, she told Estelle to make him wait. Estelle didn't understand."

"She could make the sound of a baby crying perfectly." Laurisa

"She had trouble with her ankles and legs - swollen ankles." Estelle

"Her fingers were always slender and nimble. She was flexible and could touch the floor. She had a thick thumbnail that got cured by vitamin E and Basic G." Estelle

"She could interact with people of all ages, races and religions." Estelle

"She never was a complainer. But when she had had too much aggravation, she would give a shriek and feel better." Estelle

"When Bubby and Bunny visited Rose and Leo in Venice, California, Zaida bought a baby grand piano in New York and wrapped it in wide red ribbon. The streamers flowed down the steps into the street to greet a happily screaming Bella when she returned." Estelle

"She got a driver's license but never drove. She might have gotten it because Leila got hers." Estelle

"I'll tell you how Bubby met Zaida…" Estelle